

Michael Cobar

Tulane University
Department of Economics
New Orleans, LA

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EDUCATION

Tulane University, New Orleans, LA

Ph.D., Economics Expected May 2027

Committee: Kevin Callison (Chair), Mary K. Olson, Jonathan Holmes, Felipe Gómez Trejos

M.S., Economics 2023

Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA

B.S., Economics, *summa cum laude* 2018

RESEARCH FIELDS

Health Behaviors, Health Economics, Applied Microeconomics

WORKING PAPERS

“Healthy Skepticism? The Effect of Medical Mistrust on Health Behaviors in the Post-COVID-19 US” (*Job Market Paper*)

“Clearer Lungs, Clearer Minds? Analyzing the Effects of Tobacco 21 Laws on Youth Smoking Behavior and Mental Health”

“Yearning to Breathe Free? Cigarette Taxes, Smoking Bans, and the Well-Being of Smokers.” (with Kevin Callison, Silda Nikaj, and Rujun Zhao)

WORK IN PROGRESS

“When Storms Strike: Air Pollution and Health Effects of Electricity Sector Disruptions” (with Felipe Gómez Trejos and Xiaochen Sun)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Certification

Graduate Pedagogy Certificate, Center for Engaged Learning and Teaching 2025

Instructor of Record

ECON 1010: Intro to Microeconomics Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant

2022-2026

ECON 1010: Intro to Microeconomics; ECON 1020: Intro to Macroeconomics; ECON 3010: Intermediate Microeconomics; PECON 3010: Positive Political Economy; ECON 4410/6410: Mathematical Economics; ECON 4550: Using Big Data to Solve Economic Problems

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Junior Analyst- Convergence Strategy Group

2025

- Compiled secondary data to use in proprietary modeling, performed descriptive data analysis, and created reports communicating findings to gaming and leisure consulting clients

Research Analyst- Lewis, Terrell & Associates 2020-2021

- Gathered data for economic modeling and generated data-centered internal reports for economic impact reports on the landfalls of hurricanes Laura and Delta in Louisiana

Production Analyst- DOXA Land Services 2019-2020

- Analyzed oil and gas production cards, well files, and field orders to create and update cumulative production reports used in project dossiers for clients

PRESENTATIONS

Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting; Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management Annual Fall Research Conference 2024

Tulane Economics Lunch Seminar 2023

FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS, AND AWARDS

Tulane University

Data, AI, and Community Research Grant, Connolly Alexander Institute for Data Science 2025
Graduate Student Summer Research Award, School of Liberal Arts 2025
Graduate Student Summer Write-up Award, School of Liberal Arts 2024
J.E. Land Grant, School of Liberal Arts 2024
Graduate Student Fellowship, School of Liberal Arts 2021-2026

Louisiana State University

Outstanding Economics and ITF Majors Award in Econometrics 2018
University Medal 2018

REFERENCES

Kevin Callison

Associate Professor
Department of Health Policy and Management and Department of Economics
Program Director, MPH in Health Policy and Management
Tulane University
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Jonathan Holmes

Assistant Professor
Department of Economics
University of Ottawa
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Mary K. Olson

Associate Professor
Department of Economics
Director, Health Policy Program, Murphy Institute's Center for Public Policy Research (CPPR)
Tulane University
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Felipe Gómez Trejos

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